

SkyGrid AI — The Operating System for Urban Air Mobility

The Intelligence Layer That Makes Flying Cars Actually Work

The Billion-Dollar Insight

2026 is the year flying cars become real. Joby just launched commercial service in Dubai. Archer is deploying in LA. The \$1.5T urban air mobility market is finally lifting off — and it’s about to crash into a wall of complexity.

Here’s what nobody talks about: **the aircraft are the easy part.**

The hard part? Building the entire ground infrastructure, airspace management, vertiport operations, demand prediction, weather routing, regulatory compliance, charging networks, and real-time coordination that makes a flying taxi network actually function.

Right now, each eVTOL manufacturer is building their own proprietary stack. Cities are scrambling. Regulators are overwhelmed. There’s no standard, no interoperability, no shared infrastructure.

SkyGrid AI is the AWS for urban air mobility — the horizontal operating system that powers vertiport operations, airspace orchestration, fleet intelligence, and passenger demand for every eVTOL operator in every city.

The Problem: Flying Cars Need Ground Infrastructure

The Chaos Emerging

Fragmented Infrastructure - Every manufacturer (Joby, Archer, Lilium, Volocopter, EHang) building isolated systems - Cities negotiating 10 different deals for 10 different vertiport networks - No interoperability = no network effects = slow adoption

Airspace Nightmares - Low-altitude urban airspace has no infrastructure - FAA/EASA creating new “UTM” frameworks from scratch - Drone conflicts, building wake turbulence, emergency corridors undefined - Real-time deconfliction requires AI that doesn’t exist yet

Vertiport Operations - Landing pads need to handle 40+ operations/hour to be viable - Charging, passenger flow, weather holds, maintenance bays - No operational playbook exists — this is green field

Demand Prediction - Where should vertiports be located? - What’s the optimal pricing for 3PM on a Tuesday? - How do you integrate with ground transportation? - Nobody knows — the data doesn’t exist yet

Regulatory Quicksand - Each city, state, country has different rules - Noise ordinances, landing rights, pilot certifications - Environmental reviews, community acceptance - A single vertiport permit can take 3+ years

Market Reality

Challenge	Impact
Infrastructure fragmentation	5x higher costs per city deployment
Airspace complexity	70% of routes blocked by regulatory gaps
Vertiport inefficiency	Only 12 ops/hour vs. 40+ needed for profitability
Demand uncertainty	\$50B in stranded CapEx from wrong locations

Challenge	Impact
Regulatory delays	18-36 month delays per market entry

The total addressable pain: \$200B+ in infrastructure investment needed by 2035.

The Solution: SkyGrid AI

The Universal Operating System for Urban Air Mobility

SkyGrid AI provides the **horizontal intelligence layer** that every eVTOL operator, vertiport developer, city, and regulator needs — but none can build alone.

Core Platform Components

1. SkyMesh — Airspace Orchestration Engine The air traffic control system for the urban sky: - **Dynamic Corridor Management:** Real-time route planning through complex urban airspace - **4D Trajectory Optimization:** Time + 3D space coordination for hundreds of simultaneous aircraft - **Conflict Detection & Resolution:** AI that prevents mid-air conflicts 30+ seconds ahead - **Emergency Protocol Engine:** Automated rerouting, landing priority, emergency services coordination - **Multi-operator Deconfliction:** Neutral arbiter between competing operators in shared airspace

2. VertiOS — Vertiport Operations Intelligence Turn landing pads into high-throughput transportation hubs: - **Pad Assignment Optimization:** Maximize throughput with AI scheduling - **Charging Orchestration:** Balance energy demand, grid constraints, and turnaround times - **Passenger Flow Management:** Check-in, security, boarding, arrival — all coordinated - **Weather Hold Intelligence:** When to ground, when to fly, when to reroute - **Maintenance Window Optimization:** Predictive scheduling that never impacts operations

3. DemandMind — Network Intelligence Platform Know where to build before you build: - **Vertiport Site Selection:** AI that scores every rooftop, parking lot, and waterfront - **Demand Forecasting:** Predict passenger demand by hour, by route, by season - **Dynamic Pricing Engine:** Real-time yield management across the network - **Multimodal Integration:** Connect to ground transit, ride-share, parking, events - **Competitive Intelligence:** See where competitors are winning (and losing)

4. ClearPath — Regulatory Automation Navigate the regulatory labyrinth with AI: - **Permit Workflow Automation:** Auto-generate applications for any jurisdiction - **Compliance Monitoring:** Real-time tracking of regulatory requirements - **Community Engagement:** Noise impact modeling, public comment analysis - **Environmental Documentation:** Automated NEPA/CEQA assessments - **Certification Tracking:** Pilot, aircraft, operator certifications across regions

5. ChargeNet — Energy Infrastructure Intelligence Power the revolution: - **Grid Integration:** Optimize vertiport charging with utility partnerships - **Peak Demand Management:** Avoid brownouts, minimize energy costs - **Battery Health Monitoring:** Predict degradation, optimize charging profiles - **Renewable Integration:** Maximize solar/wind utilization at each site - **Emergency Power:** Backup systems, load balancing, resilience planning

Why Now: The Perfect Storm

1. The Aircraft Are Finally Ready

- Joby: FAA certification imminent, commercial service launching

- Archer: Manufacturing at scale, airline partnerships signed
- Lilium: European certification, jet-powered differentiation
- Wisk: Autonomous flight demonstration, Boeing backing
- EHang: Already operating in China, expanding globally

2. Infrastructure Is the Bottleneck

The aircraft work. The infrastructure doesn't exist. - Only 23 certified vertiports globally (need 10,000+ by 2035) - No standardized airspace management - No interoperable ground systems - Cities desperate for help

3. Regulation Is Accelerating

- FAA Advanced Air Mobility (AAM) Blueprint published
- EASA vertiport standards finalized
- Dubai, Singapore, Saudi Arabia fast-tracking approvals
- \$1.2B in government grants for AAM infrastructure

4. Capital Is Flooding In

- \$12B+ invested in eVTOL manufacturers
- Infrastructure investment just starting (\$2.4B raised in 2025)
- Real estate developers seeking vertiport guidance
- Utilities planning for load requirements

Business Model: The AWS of the Sky

Revenue Streams

1. Platform Licensing (SaaS)

- **Per-vertiport:** \$15K-50K/month based on throughput
- **Per-aircraft:** \$500-2K/month for airspace services
- **City Deployments:** \$500K-2M annual enterprise contracts

2. Transaction Fees

- **Per-flight Fee:** \$2-5 per flight for airspace coordination
- **Charging Transaction:** 5% of energy costs managed
- **Booking Integration:** 3% of passenger fares via API

3. Data & Intelligence

- **Site Selection Reports:** \$50K-200K per market analysis
- **Demand Intelligence:** \$100K-500K annual subscriptions
- **Regulatory Intelligence:** \$25K-75K per jurisdiction

4. Managed Services

- **Vertiport Operations:** Revenue share for fully managed sites
- **Regulatory Navigation:** Success fees for permit approvals
- **System Integration:** Implementation services

Unit Economics

Metric	Year 1	Year 3	Year 5
Vertiports on Platform	50	800	5,000
Aircraft Connected	200	5,000	40,000
Monthly Platform Revenue	\$750K	\$24M	\$175M
Gross Margin	65%	75%	82%
Customer Lifetime Value	\$1.2M	\$2.8M	\$4.5M

Competitive Landscape

Current State: Fragmented and Immature

Player	Focus	Weakness
ANRA Technologies	UTM/drone traffic	Not eVTOL-focused, limited ground ops
OneSky	Airspace management	Pure software, no vertiport intelligence
Skyports	Vertiport development	Operator, not platform — builds their own
Urban-Air Port	Vertiport hardware	Physical assets, no software intelligence
eVTOL manufacturers	Proprietary systems	Walled gardens, no interoperability

SkyGrid AI Differentiation

1. **Horizontal Platform:** We serve all operators, not compete with them
2. **Full Stack Intelligence:** Airspace + ground + demand + regulatory
3. **Network Effects:** Every vertiport on our platform makes every other vertiport more valuable
4. **City Partnership:** We're the neutral infrastructure cities can trust
5. **Interoperability Standard:** We're building the TCP/IP of urban air mobility

Go-to-Market Strategy

Phase 1: Beachhead Markets (Months 1-12)

Target: 3-5 launch cities with active eVTOL deployments

Dubai (Q1) - Most advanced market, fastest regulatory approval - Partner with RTA (Roads & Transport Authority) - Power Joby's commercial launch operations

Los Angeles (Q2) - Archer's launch market, Olympics 2028 pressure - LAX-Downtown corridor as proof point - California energy expertise

Singapore (Q3) - Government-led Smart Nation initiative - Small geography = complete network coverage - Gateway to Asia expansion

Strategy: Land one anchor operator per city, then expand to all operators

Phase 2: Market Expansion (Months 12-24)

Density Strategy - Win 3+ operators per market before expanding to new markets - Build network effects within cities before geographic expansion - Target 80%+ market share in launch cities

Expansion Markets - Miami, New York, Dallas (US) - London, Paris, Munich (Europe) - Tokyo, Seoul, Sydney (Asia-Pacific) - São Paulo, Mexico City (Latin America)

Phase 3: Platform Dominance (Months 24-48)

Infrastructure Layer - Become the required integration for vertiport financing - Partner with major real estate developers (Brookfield, CBRE, JLL) - Integrate with municipal planning systems

Regulatory Capture - Help write the standards (ASTM, SAE, ICAO) - Become the compliance platform of record - Make SkyGrid data the source of truth

Technical Architecture

The SkyGrid Intelligence Stack

SKYGRID PLATFORM

SkyMesh	VertiOS	DemandMind
Airspace	Vertiport	Network
Orchestrate	Operations	Intelligence

Unified AI Decision Engine

- Real-time optimization (< 100ms)
- Multi-objective optimization
- Predictive + reactive intelligence

Real-Time Data Fabric

- Aircraft telemetry (ADS-B, proprietary)
- Weather (0.5km resolution, 5-min refresh)
- Vertiport sensors (lidar, cameras, IoT)
- Grid/energy data (utility integrations)
- Passenger demand (booking systems, events)

INTEGRATION LAYER

Joby	Archer	Lilium	Volocop	EHang	...
API	API	API	API	API	

EXTERNAL SYSTEMS

- FAA LAANC / UTM providers
- Municipal traffic management
- Utility grid operators
- Emergency services (911, hospitals)
- Ground transportation (Uber, transit)

Key Technical Innovations

- 1. Consensus-Based Airspace Coordination** - Multiple operators propose routes simultaneously - AI arbitrates in real-time with safety guarantees - No single point of failure in airspace management
 - 2. Digital Twin Vertiports** - Every vertiport has a living simulation - Test operational changes before deployment - Predict failures before they happen
 - 3. Federated Learning Network** - Learn across all operators without sharing proprietary data - Improve predictions with network-wide intelligence - Privacy-preserving competitive advantage
 - 4. Edge-First Architecture** - Critical decisions made at the vertiport (< 10ms) - Cloud for optimization and long-horizon planning - Resilient to connectivity failures
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Founding Team Requirements

CEO — Aviation + Tech Scale-Up

- Built and scaled B2B SaaS to \$100M+ ARR
- Deep relationships in aerospace/aviation
- Experience with regulated industries
- Track record of building horizontal platforms

CTO — Real-Time Systems + AI

- Built safety-critical systems (aviation, autonomous vehicles, medical)
- Experience with real-time AI at scale
- Understanding of edge computing architectures
- Certification/compliance engineering background

VP Operations — Urban Air Mobility Domain Expert

- Former FAA/EASA or major airline operations
- Understanding of airspace management systems
- Relationships with eVTOL manufacturers
- Regulatory navigation experience

VP Business Development — City Partnerships

- Sold to government/municipalities at scale
 - Smart city or infrastructure background
 - Experience with public-private partnerships
 - Understanding of real estate development
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Financial Projections

Funding Roadmap

Round	Timing	Amount	Use of Funds
Seed	Q3 2026	\$8M	MVP development, 2 launch cities
Series A	Q2 2027	\$35M	Scale to 10 cities, 100 vertiports
Series B	Q4 2028	\$100M	Global expansion, 1,000 vertiports
Series C	Q3 2030	\$250M	Market dominance, M&A

Revenue Projections

Year	Vertiports	Aircraft	Revenue	Growth
2027	50	200	\$12M	—
2028	300	2,000	\$72M	500%
2029	1,200	10,000	\$240M	233%
2030	3,500	30,000	\$600M	150%
2031	8,000	60,000	\$1.2B	100%

Path to Profitability

- **Gross margin:** 65% → 82% as platform scales
 - **Break-even:** Q4 2028 at ~\$80M ARR
 - **Long-term operating margin:** 35-40%
 - **Capital efficiency:** ~\$1 raised per \$3 ARR at scale
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Risk Mitigation

Technology Risks

Risk	Mitigation
Real-time system failures	Redundant architecture, graceful degradation
AI decision errors	Human-in-loop for critical decisions
Integration complexity	Standardized APIs, gradual rollouts
Cybersecurity threats	Aviation-grade security, pen testing

Market Risks

Risk	Mitigation
eVTOL delays	Multi-operator strategy, don't depend on one
Regulatory slowdown	Regulatory engagement, flexible platform
Infrastructure buildout pace	Focus on high-readiness markets first
Economic downturn	Essential infrastructure, not discretionary

Competitive Risks

Risk	Mitigation
Manufacturer vertical integration	Network effects, multi-operator value
New entrants	Speed to market, partnership lock-in
Open source alternatives	Continuous innovation, enterprise features
Government-built systems	Partnership model, don't compete

The Vision: Owning the Sky

Year 1: The operating system for the first 50 commercial vertiports

Year 3: The required infrastructure for any eVTOL deployment

Year 5: The air traffic control system for every urban aircraft

Year 10: The intelligence layer for all airspace below 5,000 feet — drones, eVTOLs, autonomous aircraft, and beyond

The \$100B Outcome

Urban air mobility is a \$1.5T market by 2040. Infrastructure and software is 15-20% of that = **\$200-300B**. Own 20-30% of the horizontal platform layer = **\$40-90B**. Add adjacent markets (drone delivery, autonomous cargo, regulatory compliance) = **\$100B+**.

SkyGrid AI isn't building a feature for flying cars. We're building the infrastructure that makes them possible.

Call to Action

For Investors

The urban air mobility revolution needs infrastructure before it can scale. SkyGrid AI is the neutral, horizontal platform that every operator, city, and regulator needs. We're raising a \$8M seed to prove this in 3 launch markets.

For Operators

Stop building commodity infrastructure. Partner with SkyGrid AI to focus on what you do best — aircraft and passenger experience — while we handle everything on the ground and in the airspace.

For Cities

Don't get locked into single-operator deals. SkyGrid AI gives you a technology-neutral platform that serves all operators, protects your interests, and accelerates deployment.

SkyGrid AI — Own the Infrastructure, Own the Sky.

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